

Article Title Naming Convention — Developer Spec

This describes how the **Title** field (Contentful metadata tab) is constructed for every published article/video. Goal: give the piece's own distinguishing content the front of the string, since browser tabs and Google search snippets truncate around 20-30 characters — anything after that point may never be seen.

1. Universal shape

Every title follows the same three-part shape, in this order:

{distinguishing content}, {generic series/category label} | Payden & Rygel

- **Distinguishing content** — whatever makes *this* piece different from every other piece in the same series: a headline, a date, a volume number, a month/period, a trip destination, etc. Always goes **first**.
- **Series/category label** — the generic bucket this piece belongs to (e.g. "Week in Review," "Trip Notes," "Point of View Vol. 2 2026"). Always goes **second**, as a secondary clause.
- **Brand suffix** — literally | Payden & Rygel, fixed, always last.

Rule of thumb: if you covered up everything after the first comma, could someone still tell which specific piece this is? If not, the order is wrong.

There are two exceptions to this three-part shape: hub/landing pages (a table-of-contents page for a whole volume/issue — see section 4) and Research Papers (no recurring series, so no series-label clause — see section 3).

2. How to find the “distinguishing content” (source priority)

Pull from the live page in this order — first one found wins:

1. A real editorial headline genuinely present and prominent in the page body (not a nav label or generic subheading).
2. Text tied to the hero banner image itself (caption, alt text, overlay copy).
3. Constructed from the URL slug + core theme of the body, written as a clean headline (not a filename).

Sanity check: compare the candidate against the URL slug before finalizing. If they don't reasonably match, you probably grabbed a subheading instead of the real title — search the raw HTML for text resembling the slug's own words (link text, PDF titles, image alt text).

Max length: 256 characters total (whole title string, not just this part).

3. Per-series formats + examples

Series	Template	Distinguishing content =	Confirm exam
Week in Review	{Headline}, {DATE_ISO} Week in Review \\ Payden & Rygel	On-page headline + displayed publish date (YYYY-MM-DD)	Running 2026-08- Week in Review \\ Payden & Rygel
Emerging Markets Monthly Commentary	{Month} {Year} Monthly Commentary, Emerging Markets \\ Payden & Rygel	The commentary <i>period</i> the piece covers (from the page, not necessarily the publish date)	July 202 Monthly Commenta Emerging Markets Payden & Rygel
Trip Notes	{Title}, Trip Notes \\ & Rygel	Exact on-page title, worded as-is (no paraphrasing)	Western Balkans, Trip Not \\ Payden & Rygel (constru not yet confirm live)
Point of View (individual article)	{Leading Title}, Point of View Vol. {N} {Year} \\ Payden & Rygel	Leading/starting portion of the article's own title; volume + year exactly as stated on page, no comma between them	Wisdom (C The Crow Point of View Vol 2026 \\ Payden & Rygel
Economic Update	{Full headline}, {Report/Series Name} \\ & Rygel	Full on-page headline (not truncated) + the specific report name (not the umbrella "Economic Update" label)	What We Learned H1 2026 And What That Imp For Our Outlook, Mid-Year Macro Outlook Payden & Rygel
Research Paper (confirmed 2026-08-19)	{Article Title} \\ Payden & Rygel	The paper's own on-page title, detected the normal way (section 2) — no series-label clause at all, since a Research Paper isn't part of a recurring/numbered/dated series	—
Any other/new series	{distinguishing detail}, {Series Name} \\ Payden & Rygel	Whatever tells this piece apart from others in the series: a date (date-driven series), a month/period (periodic), a volume/edition number (numbered), or the exact on-page title (one- off/named piece)	—

Notes on specific fields: - **Series/category label** is detected from the page's own category tag, breadcrumb, or URL path segment — never guessed from tone. - **Volume/edition numbers** are never inferred or incremented — if not explicitly stated on the page, flag it rather than guess. - **Casing**: "Week in Review" (lowercase "in") in the title string — note this differs from the Title Case used elsewhere in body copy. - **Research Paper is a structural exception**, not just another row: it drops the secondary series-label clause entirely rather than filling it with something generic. This rule was added because the skill previously had no matching format for an obviously-titled research paper and failed to produce a Title for it — check the page's own category/breadcrumb label to confirm a piece is a Research Paper rather than a Point of View article or Economic Update before applying this format, and ask if that's ambiguous.

4. Hub / landing pages (exception to section 1)

A hub page is a table-of-contents for a volume/issue — multiple distinct articles, each with its own URL, no single continuous narrative of its own. Detect by checking the raw HTML for links to article-specific slugs nested under the same path.

Since a hub page has no single headline to front-load, its format is simpler — just the series identifier + brand suffix:

{Series Name} Vol. {N} {Year} | Payden & Rygel

or, for a non-volume-numbered series:

{Series Name}: {period} | Payden & Rygel

Confirmed example: Point of View Vol. 2 2026 | Payden & Rygel

5. Automation checklist for the developer

1. Fetch the live page (rendered HTML — some content, including the title, may only exist in a Next.js streaming payload in a `<script>` tag rather than plain rendered HTML; check raw source if the rendered fetch comes back empty).
 2. Determine content type: single article/video vs. hub/landing page (look for multiple distinct article-slug links nested under the same path).
 3. Determine which series it belongs to (category tag / breadcrumb / URL segment).
 4. Extract the distinguishing content per the source-priority order in section 2, using the field mapping for that series from the table in section 3.
 5. Run the slug-match sanity check from section 2.
 6. Assemble the string per the template for that series (or the hub template if step 2 said hub).
 7. Enforce 256-character max on the full string.
 8. If any required field (volume number, date, series name) is missing from the page, don't guess — flag for manual entry instead of publishing a constructed value silently.
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6. Retired format (do not use)

The old convention put the brand/series name first: Payden {Series Name}: {Title}. This is retired — it burns the truncation-visible window on a generic prefix instead of the piece's own distinguishing content. Any older Titles still using this pattern are legacy, not a template to replicate going forward.